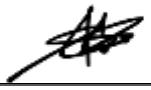
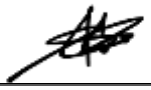
	DECLARATION OF PERSONNEL COMPETENCE		
	Document no: ASMF 6.2 PROCEDURE		
	Compiled by:	**Tshepo Maponya – Laboratory Supervisor**	
	Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

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09/2025	02	09/2028

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1. Purpose

To define the process for evaluating, declaring, and maintaining the competence of personnel performing laboratory activities in compliance with **ISO/IEC 17025:2017 Clause 6.2**.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all laboratory personnel involved in testing, calibration, sampling, reporting of results, and supporting technical functions.

3. References

- ISO/IEC 17025:2017, Clauses 6.2.1 – 6.2.6
- Laboratory Quality Manual(ASDP001)
- Competence Declaration of Competence form (ASMF6.1 Form)

4. Definitions

- **Competence:** Demonstrated ability to apply knowledge and skills to perform assigned tasks.
- **Authorization:** Formal approval by the Laboratory Manager or Supervisor permitting personnel to carry out specific laboratory tasks unsupervised.
- **Technical Assessment:** A structured theoretical evaluation that verifies understanding of method principles, calculations, and quality requirements.

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5. Responsibilities

Roles	Responsibilities
Laboratory Manager / Supervisor	• Ensures training, assessments, and witnessing are conducted; approves final competence declarations. • Maintains competence records and monitors retraining needs.
Operator / Analyst	• Participates in training and assessment; ensures competence is maintained through ongoing performance. • Analyst/operator deemed competent by lab manager/supervisor can train other personnel.

6. Procedure

6.1 Determination of Competence Requirements

- For each test method or activity, minimum competence requirements shall be defined, including:
    - Education level or technical background
    - Method-specific training
    - Practical laboratory experience
    - Understanding of quality system procedures (QMS, ISO 17025, ISO 17034 & ISO 17043 requirements)

Onboarding Lab Supervisors/Managers with prior technical signatory appointment in a similar accredited laboratory do not need test method training/witnessing; only the

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theoretical assessments and running of a PT sample for competency evaluation should suffice.

The Director of the organization has full responsibility for appointing a nominated representative (NR), appointing and authorizing all technical signatories(TS).

6.2 Training Process

- Onboarding personnel shall undergo **initial method training** conducted by a competent analyst or supervisor.
- The training includes:
    1. **Review of the method procedure (SOP).**
    2. **Explanation of the purpose, principle, and critical control points.**
    3. **Demonstration of the method by a qualified analyst/operator.**
    4. **Supervised performance of the method by the trainee.**

6.3 Technical (Theoretical) Assessment

- Following training, the trainee shall complete a **written technical assessment** to evaluate:
    - Understanding of the analytical principles
    - Calculations and data interpretation
    - Equipment operation and safety
    - Awareness of method limitations and potential sources of error

Results are recorded and evaluated by the Laboratory manager/supervisor or competent analyst.

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6.4 Practical Witnessing

- The trainee performs the full method **independently under observation** by a qualified witness (Supervisor or Manager or competent personnel).
- The witness completes a **Witnessing form (SANAS F15-11)** confirming satisfactory performance of:
    - Sample handling and preparation
    - Instrument use and calibration
    - Data recording and reporting
    - Compliance with the SOP and safety rules
    - Walkthrough on the method critical points

6.5 Authorization and Declaration

- Upon successful completion of:
    - Method training
    - Technical (theoretical) assessment
    - Practical witnessing

The **Laboratory Manager/Supervisor** authorizes the individual to perform the specific test method **without supervision**.

Authorization is documented on the **Competence Declaration Form (ASMF 6.1 FORM)**, signed by both the Manager/Supervisor and the authorized staff member.

6.6 Ongoing Competence Monitoring

- Competence shall be re-evaluated:
    - Annually, or

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- After major method revisions, extended absence, or poor PT performance.
- Ongoing competence monitoring shall be conducted via witnessing with the usage of ASMF 6.2B form.

- Refresher training or reauthorization shall be conducted if needed.

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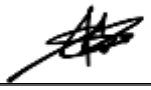
7. Records

Record Name	Form No.	Retention Period
Competence Declaration Form	ASMF 6.1 FORM	10 years
SANAS	F 15-11	10 years

8. Related Documents

- Quality Manual(ASDP001)
- SANAS (F15-11)
- SOPs for individual test methods (e.g. AS001IW,AS003IW,AS007IW etc.)
- ASMF 6.2B

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	Document no: **ASMF 6.2 PROCEDURE**		
	Compiled by:	**Tshepo Maponya – Laboratory Supervisor**	
	Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

Revision

Revision no	Content changed	Effective Date
01	No changes, additional information under section 6.1. 'On boarding supervisors/ managers'	February 2026
02	Responsibilities of analyst/operator have been updated, as initially the document did not specify that analyst/operators deemed competent can train other personnel.	September 2026
02	Ongoing competency shall be conducted using ASMF 6.2B form instead of SANAS F15-11	September 2026

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